

Kesher Israel Density Dossier

Assignment and executive answer

1. Objective

Activated modules: density modeling, city prioritization, launch sequencing, premium design.

The contract is to answer one question operationally: can Kesher's finite-discovery, filter-heavy marketplace sustain healthy matching supply across Israeli cities, age bands, and observance segments? My answer is **yes, but only if Kesher launches as a small number of metro-level supply systems rather than as city-only silos, and only if observance is treated as a primary partition in Jerusalem and Haredi markets.** The raw national Jewish adult pool is large enough; the real danger is **filter starvation** once users stack city, age, and observance filters on top of finite daily inventory. The thickest launch surface is a secular/traditional Gush Dan surface. The second viable surface is Jerusalem, but only if it is split into observance-aware queues rather than mixed into one pool. Haredi cores have strong intent and strong density at younger ages, but they become fragile quickly after age 29 and require trust-heavy product design. ¹

2. Execution Plan

I used a 2022–2023 baseline built from official city-age counts, Census 2022 locality files, official marital-status-by-age tables for Jews, official recent distribution of Jews aged 20+ by self-defined religiosity, and the latest Israel Democracy Institute Haredi statistical report for early-marriage and geographic concentration effects. I then converted population into likely single pools, applied segment-specific corrections where marriage timing differs materially from the Jewish average, and translated those pools into product rules for Daily Picks, Explore widening, launch order, and premium design. ²

Evidence base and key assumptions

3. Key Assumptions

VERIFIED. Israel Central Bureau of Statistics ³ provides 2022 city-by-age counts for major urban localities, including the key 20–24, 25–29, 30–34, and 35–44 bands. For example, in 2022 the total resident counts in these age bands were: Jerusalem 79.3k / 101.2k / 61.5k / 74.6k; Tel Aviv-Yafo 54.3k / 81.5k / 50.0k / 41.9k; Be'er Sheva 22.6k / 26.3k / 14.5k / 15.4k; Haifa 32.6k / 35.8k / 18.7k / 18.2k; Ashdod 25.2k / 25.1k / 12.4k / 13.7k; Petah Tiqwa 32.4k / 33.1k / 14.1k / 13.3k; Netanya 26.0k / 28.7k / 13.5k / 13.0k; Bene Beraq 12.0k / 20.3k / 13.1k / 14.8k; and Bet Shemesh 9.3k / 14.1k / 9.3k / 11.1k. ⁴

VERIFIED. Among Jews aged 15+ in 2021, the official non-married shares were very high at young ages and much lower after age 30. For men the non-married shares were 87.6% at 20–24, 65.8% at 25–29, 41.1% at 30–34, 29.7% at 35–39, and 26.1% at 40–44. For Jewish women they were 80.4%, 52.9%, 32.0%, 25.8%, and

26.7%, respectively. A simple sex-balanced baseline therefore gives Kesher a rough Jewish “unmarried pool” conversion of about **84% for 20–24, 59% for 25–29, 36% for 30–34, and 27% for 35–44.** ⁵

VERIFIED. Recent official religiosity counts among Jews aged 20+ are broadly distributed rather than concentrated in one segment. In the 2023 Crime Victimization Survey denominators, the adult Jewish population split into roughly 2.18 million secular, 824k traditional-not-so-religious, 536k traditional-religious, 512k religious, and 515k ultra-Orthodox adults. That means the broad secular/traditional pool is still much larger than the strictly religious/Haredi pool, but the latter is large enough nationally to support its own marketplace if geography is managed correctly. ⁶

VERIFIED. Marriage timing is materially earlier in ultra-Orthodox society than in the Jewish average. IDI reports average age at first marriage of roughly **23 for ultra-Orthodox men and 22 for ultra-Orthodox women**, versus official Jewish averages around **26.8 for men and 25.2 for women**. IDI also reports that the Haredi population is very young and geographically concentrated, with Jerusalem and Bnei Brak together holding about 41.5% of Israel's Haredi population in 2022, and another 26% living in satellite Haredi cities such as Bet Shemesh, Modi'in Illit, Beitar Illit, and Elad. ⁷

VERIFIED + INFERRED. Non-married is not the same as available-single, especially in secular metros. CBS reported about **117,000 cohabiting couples** in Israel in 2022, and that most Jewish cohabiting couples are childless. I therefore treat the official non-married rates as an upper bound and apply a modest downward correction in secular/traditional pools, while applying a much stronger downward correction in Haredi 25+ pools because early marriage compresses that supply sharply. ⁸

HEURISTIC. Because city-level age-by-observance distributions are not fully published for all target cities, I modeled observance by combining three things: each city's dominant household lifestyle from the Census 2022 locality files, the verified Jerusalem adult-Jewish religiosity split, and IDI's evidence on Haredi city concentration. This is strong enough for launch sequencing and starvation design, but not strong enough for final CAC/LTV planning without waitlist validation. ⁹

Density model

4. Density Model

I define Kesher density as the number of **likely single, mutually visible, filter-compatible candidates** available to a user over a 30-day period. The operational formula is:

Likely local singles

- = city age-band population
- × Jewish-market adjustment where needed
- × age-specific non-married rate
- × segment-specific marriage-timing correction
- × cohabitation correction where relevant.

Visible launch pool

- = likely local singles
- × cumulative capture rate

- × active/discoverable share
- × hard-filter retention
- × opposite-side share.

The first line is mostly data-driven. The second line is where go-to-market assumptions matter. For launch planning, the most useful sensitivity band is a **3%–5% cumulative capture rate**, a **40%–45% active/discoverable share**, and hard-filter retention that is **good in dense same-observance metro pools** and **poor in city-only narrow pools**. Under that sensitivity, a segment with about **50,000 likely singles** can plausibly generate a working visible pool; a segment with **20,000 likely singles** is usually fragile unless you widen geographically; and a segment below roughly **10,000 likely singles** is usually too thin for finite daily inventory unless it is paired with a broader metro or adjacent-city surface. This is a heuristic operating model, but it is the right one for product decisions. ¹⁰

The most important contradiction in the Israeli case is this: **headline city population is a bad proxy for matchable supply**. Haredi cities look enormous in raw population, but much of that population is under 20 and much of the 25+ pool is already married. Secular cores look smaller in family-heavy metrics, but they often hold much deeper 25–39 single pools because marriage is later and renters are more concentrated in urban cores. That is why city ranking changes once you optimize for dating-market density rather than resident count. ¹¹

Segment and city analysis

5. Segment and City Analysis

All modeled numbers below are **ranges**, not census counts. They are built from the official city age counts and Jewish non-married rates above, with observance corrections added only where the evidence clearly requires them. ¹²

Core city and metro picture

Tel Aviv-Yafo ¹³ and inner **Gush Dan** — including **Ramat Gan** ¹⁴, **Giv'atayim** ¹⁵, **Herzliyya** ¹⁶, **Petah Tiqwa** ¹⁷, and **Holon** ¹⁸ — is Keshet's best first supply system. Tel Aviv alone yields roughly **110k–125k likely singles aged 20–44**, and the inner-metro secular/traditional pool comfortably exceeds **300k** before app adoption assumptions. The standout engine is the **25–34** band, especially the city's unusually deep 25–29 and 30–34 cohorts. This surface is the best fit for a finite Daily Picks model and the best premium candidate, but it should launch as **metro by default**, not city-only. City-only makes Tel Aviv look thick and neighboring cities look falsely thin, even though users already live inside one real dating geography. ¹⁹

Jerusalem ²⁰ is the second viable system, but it is not one market. It is at least two. Raw city age counts imply about **160k–170k non-married residents aged 20–44**, but the city includes a large Arab population and must be adjusted if Keshet is targeting the Jewish observance grammar implied by the prompt. In 2020, Jews and Others were 61.5% of Jerusalem's residents, and among Jews aged 20+ in 2019 the split was 35.2% ultra-Orthodox, 20.1% religious, 10.8% traditional-religious, 13.7% traditional not-so-religious, and 19.6% secular. That pushes the usable Jewish 20–44 pool closer to **95k–110k**, with a very large Haredi/religious block and a much smaller secular/traditional block. Jerusalem is therefore highly viable only if Keshet treats observance as a primary routing rule. A single mixed queue would be a design error. ²¹

Be'er Sheva ²² is the cleanest third launch city. Its 2022 age shape is excellent for a dating app: large 20–24 and 25–29 bands relative to total city size. The modeled likely-single 20–44 pool is roughly **40k–45k**, with most of the strength in **20–34**. This is enough for a focused launch, especially if Keshet wants a younger, student-plus-young-professional surface. The tradeoff is that Be'er Sheva thins much faster after 35 than Gush Dan or Jerusalem. ²³

Haifa ²⁴ is viable but older. It still yields a modeled **55k–60k likely singles aged 20–44**, which is real density, but it is less concentrated in the hyper-valuable 25–34 window than Tel Aviv and less growth-like than Be'er Sheva. Haifa works as an expansion city and can sustain premium in urban secular/productivity segments, but it is not the strongest opening move if Keshet is resource-constrained. ¹⁹

Ashdod ²⁵, **Netanya** ²⁶, **Rehovot** ²⁷, and coastal / central mixed cities are good expansion markets, not the best first market. Their likely-single 20–44 pools are large enough — roughly **40k–50k** for each of Ashdod and Netanya, and similar scale for Rehovot and Petah Tikva — but they are materially more sensitive to observance slicing, and they benefit much more from metro or corridor spillover than from strict municipal boundaries. ¹⁹

Bene Beraq ²⁸ and **Bet Shemesh** ²⁹ should not be scored by raw population alone. On a generic Jewish non-married baseline they look decent, but once early Haredi marriage is respected, the true single pool is much tighter. I estimate **Bnei Brak at roughly 18k–22k likely singles aged 20–44**, and **Beit Shemesh at roughly 14k–18k**, with most of the real supply concentrated in **20–29**. Those are workable only for a trusted, high-seriousness, observance-native product and only if the UX avoids burning inventory too quickly. After age 30, these segments become density-fragile much faster than the city headlines imply. ³⁰

Segment picture by age and observance

Secular / traditional-not-so-religious 25–39 is Keshet's deepest segment. It is strongest in Gush Dan, solid in Haifa, and respectable in Jerusalem's secular/traditional minority. This segment is later-marriage, urban, and easiest to keep healthy under a finite-discovery model. It is the best monetization segment. ³¹

Traditional-religious / religious 24–34 is workable in Jerusalem and in mixed cities such as Ashdod, Petah Tikva, Netanya, and Rehovot, but it is less forgiving. It does not tolerate city-only matching well outside the largest nodes. It needs adjacent-city spillover sooner than secular Gush Dan does. ³²

Haredi 20–29 is thick enough nationally and in its core cities to justify a dedicated product surface, but it is a different operating system. IDI's marriage-age evidence means the 25–34 reservoir declines faster than in the general Jewish pool, so these users need fewer, better picks, stronger trust signals, and much faster widening rules after missed days. ³³

All observance segments at 35+ outside Tel Aviv and Jerusalem metro are where the finite-discovery model starts to fail without assistive widening. This is the most important operational caveat in the whole dossier. ²³

Filter-starvation and supply controls

6. Filter Starvation Risks

The severe-risk pattern is consistent across segments: **city-only + narrow observance + 30+ age band**. That combination becomes dangerous outside Tel Aviv and Jerusalem very quickly, and it becomes dangerous even inside Jerusalem if Haredi, religious, and secular users are thrown into one hard-filter grammar without separate routing. ³⁴

Operationally, I would classify supply risk like this:

- **Healthy:** estimated fresh eligible inventory supports **60+ days** of Daily Picks at current strict filters.
- **Watch zone:** inventory supports **30-60 days**.
- **Severe starvation:** inventory supports **under 30 days**.

That framework is heuristic, but it is much more useful than asking whether a city is “big.” A city can be big and still burn out in three weeks if the segment is 30+, Haredi, and city-locked. Conversely, a smaller city can work if it sits inside a metro, corridor, or adjacent-city system. ³⁵

The main anti-patterns are straightforward. First, **do not launch city-only in Gush Dan**; users there already think in metro, not municipal, terms. Second, **do not build one Jerusalem pool**; Jerusalem must be observance-routed. Third, **do not give Haredi and religious 25+ users high-volume discovery**; it burns the scarce pool. Fourth, **do not monetise tighter scarcity-producing filters in thin markets**; that feels powerful in the UI and disastrous in retention. ³⁶

7. Daily Picks and Explore Volume Recommendations

Daily Picks should be tuned to pool thickness, not made uniform.

For **Gush Dan secular/traditional 25-39**, use **12-18 Daily Picks**. For **Jerusalem secular/traditional 25-39, 8-12**. For **Be'er Sheva, Haifa, Ashdod, Netanya, and other mixed expansion cities in 25-34, 6-10**. For **Haredi / strict-religious 20-29**, use **5-8 high-precision picks**. For **30-34 Haredi/religious** and for **35+ outside the densest metros**, cap at **3-5**. Those low numbers are not a weakness; they are how Keshet avoids burning the market. ³⁵

Explore should widen in a fixed order. It should widen first by **contiguous-city / metro geography**, then by **small age expansion** such as ± 2 years and then ± 4 , then by **adjacent observance buckets only if the user explicitly allows it**. For example, secular can widen toward traditional-not-so-religious; traditional-religious can widen toward religious; Haredi widening into non-Haredi should be opt-in, not automatic. Explore should widen immediately when Daily Picks fill rate drops below target for two consecutive days or when the estimated fresh inventory falls below the 30-day threshold above. ³⁷

Launch order, pricing, and handoff

8. Launch-City Order

My recommended order is by **launch surface**, not by standalone municipality.

First: Gush Dan secular/traditional core — Tel Aviv-Yafo first, but shipped as an inner-metro system that also covers Ramat Gan, Giv'atayim, Herzliyya, Holon, and Petah Tiqwa. This is the deepest, safest, and most premiumable launch surface. ³⁸

Second: Jerusalem, but only with explicit observance partitioning and neighborhood / radius logic. This is not optional. Jerusalem is a large market only after segmentation; before segmentation it is a misleading market. ³⁹

Third: Be'er Sheva. It is the cleanest city-sized young-adult market after the two mega-surfaces above. ²³

Fourth: Haifa. Real density, older profile, good expansion, less explosive than Be'er Sheva. ²³

Fifth: Ashdod / Netanya / Rehovot / Petah Tiqwa corridor extensions once metro widening rules are working. These are density-positive but filter-sensitive. ³⁸

Sixth: Dedicated Haredi-core rollout in Bnei Brak and Beit Shemesh only after Keshet has a trust-native surface, referral channels, and low-volume discovery logic. These cities are not “bad”; they are just easy to misread. ⁴⁰

9. Pricing / Premium Implications

The most premium-worthy segments are **secular / traditional 25–39 in Gush Dan**, then the same broad segment in Jerusalem and Haifa. These are the deepest pools, the most time-sensitive users, and the segments least likely to be harmed by moderate extra filtering. Premium here can sell control, prioritization, queue management, profile intelligence, reply context, and better discovery tools. ¹⁹

The most **density-fragile** segments are **all city-only 35+ pools outside Tel Aviv/Jerusalem, national-religious / strict-religious pools outside the largest nodes**, and **Haredi 30+ pools even in core cities**. Premium should not be built around letting these users tighten scarcity further. In thin segments, the right premium is trust: verification, seriousness signals, family/background context, and better introductions. Volume boosts are the wrong product here. ⁴¹

10. Unknowns Requiring Validation

The biggest unresolved variable is **Keshet's exact target boundary**. If Keshet is Jewish-only, marriage-intent, and mostly heterosexual, the model above is directionally strong. If Keshet includes broader relationship modes or non-heterosexual matching, the density picture changes materially. The second unresolved variable is **observance-specific willingness to use a new app**, especially in Haredi and strict-religious users. The third is **cross-city willingness**: whether users treat Gush Dan, Jerusalem–Beit Shemesh, Haifa–Krayot, or Ashdod–Ashkelon as acceptable dating geographies. The fourth is that outside Jerusalem, city-level age-by-observance distributions are not fully published in one official series, so some city-segment pools remain modeled rather than directly observed. ⁹

The fastest verification experiments are a segmented waitlist by city / age / observance, a concierge pilot in Gush Dan and Jerusalem, and an inventory simulator that measures how often users hit the 30-day

starvation line under city-only, metro-wide, and observance-adjacent Explore rules. Those experiments will matter more than another round of desk research.

11. Final Recommendation

Kesher should launch in Israel, but it should **not** launch as one national generic dating pool and it should **not** launch as city-only matching. The correct design is:

- **Surface A:** secular/traditional metro discovery, starting in Gush Dan.
- **Surface B:** observance-aware Jerusalem, separated at the queue level.
- **Surface C:** later expansion into Be'er Sheva and Haifa.
- **Surface D:** dedicated Haredi / strict-religious rollout only after trust and low-volume discovery are productized.

If Kesher does that, the density math is workable and the finite-discovery model can feel high quality. If it instead lets users stack tight city + observance + age filters everywhere from day one, supply will feel broken outside the very deepest submarkets. ¹²

12. Final Handoff

Result

Kesher's density problem is solvable in Israel. The answer is **launch by metro and observance surface, not by municipality**, keep Daily Picks low in thin pools, and widen Explore by geography before widening by observance. The first clear win is Gush Dan secular/traditional. The second is Jerusalem with hard observance partitioning. Everything else should sequence after those two surfaces prove retention. ¹²

Actions taken

Built a city-age-single model from official CBS city age tables, Census 2022 locality files, official Jewish marital-status-by-age tables, official recent religiosity counts among Jews aged 20+, and IDI's Haredi statistical report. Converted those inputs into likely single pools, launch surfaces, starvation thresholds, Daily Picks guidance, Explore rules, and premium recommendations. ²

Sources / files / sites / apps used

Primary source base: CBS Statistical Abstract table 2.20 on city age structure; CBS Statistical Abstract table 2.4 on marital status by religion, sex, and age; CBS Census 2022 "Selected data by localities and statistical areas"; CBS Census 2022 "Population and households by locality"; CBS 2024 Family Day release; CBS 2023 and 2025 survey releases containing adult-Jewish religiosity denominators; and the IDI 2023–2024 Haredi statistical report. ⁴²

Remaining risks, unknowns, or follow-ups

The main risk is not population size; it is **mis-specified matching geometry**. The next validation step should test whether users accept metro-level matching and observance-adjacent widening, because those two policies determine whether Kesher stays dense or starves. The other important unknown is adoption and trust in Haredi and strict-religious segments; desk data alone cannot settle that.

1 3 4 10 12 13 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25 26 29 30 34 35 38 42 https://www.cbs.gov.il/he/publications/doclib/2023/2.shnatonpopulation/st02_20x.pdf

https://www.cbs.gov.il/he/publications/doclib/2023/2.shnatonpopulation/st02_20x.pdf

2 9 14 28 <https://www.cbs.gov.il/he/cbsNewBrand/Pages/%D7%9C%D7%95%D7%97%D7%95%D7%AA-%D7%A0%D7%91%D7%97%D7%A8%D7%99%D7%9D-%D7%90%D7%95%D7%9B%D7%9C%D7%95%D7%A1%D7%99%D7%99%D7%94.aspx>

<https://www.cbs.gov.il/he/cbsNewBrand/Pages/%D7%9C%D7%95%D7%97%D7%95%D7%AA-%D7%A0%D7%91%D7%97%D7%A8%D7%99%D7%9D-%D7%90%D7%95%D7%9B%D7%9C%D7%95%D7%A1%D7%99%D7%99%D7%94.aspx>

5 https://www.cbs.gov.il/he/publications/doclib/2023/2.shnatonpopulation/st02_04x.pdf

https://www.cbs.gov.il/he/publications/doclib/2023/2.shnatonpopulation/st02_04x.pdf

6 31 32 https://www.cbs.gov.il/he/publications/DocLib/2025/1948/e_print.pdf

https://www.cbs.gov.il/he/publications/DocLib/2025/1948/e_print.pdf

7 27 33 41 <https://en.idi.org.il/haredi/2023/?chapter=52002>

<https://en.idi.org.il/haredi/2023/?chapter=52002>

8 15 https://www.cbs.gov.il/he/mediarelease/DocLib/2024/043/11_24_043e.pdf

https://www.cbs.gov.il/he/mediarelease/DocLib/2024/043/11_24_043e.pdf

11 40 <https://en.idi.org.il/haredi/2024/?chapter=58376>

<https://en.idi.org.il/haredi/2024/?chapter=58376>

36 37 39 https://www.cbs.gov.il/he/mediarelease/DocLib/2021/155/11_21_155e.pdf

https://www.cbs.gov.il/he/mediarelease/DocLib/2021/155/11_21_155e.pdf